



Trust, lead, protect

Community learning and technology to defend those who
defend us

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Overview



AdaLead is an educational and technological platform that combines a smart bracelet ("Tokay"), a mobile app and community response networks to protect journalists, environmental defenders, community leaders and families.

MISSION

Reducing the lethality of violence against those who defend territory, nature and rights, while strengthening education for peace and community trust.

VISION

A world where anyone feels safe everywhere, at all times, in the company of all kinds of people.



Opportunity for impact



2200

Environmental defenders
have been killed around the
world during the last decade.

85%

of the cases remain unpunished.

Mexico

It is among the three countries with the
most journalists killed since 2010.

Extreme violence + inadequate tools + institutional distrust

At the educational level, there are almost no systematic programs that combine critical digital literacy, human rights and peacebuilding for communities at risk; the lack of this pedagogical basis exacerbates polarization and mistrust.

Official protection mechanisms are limited: in Mexico the federal mechanism barely covers ~1,508 people (495 journalists and 1,023 defenders), leaving many activists without support.




TOKAY SYSTEM



When they sense a threat, tokay geckos emit a loud, repetitive call—their “to-kay.” This sound carries over a distance, warning other nearby individuals and sometimes deterring a potential predator.



Receiver's perspective



By shaking the bracelet, Tokay sends a signal with crucial information for a quick response to other users within a user-verified trusted network.

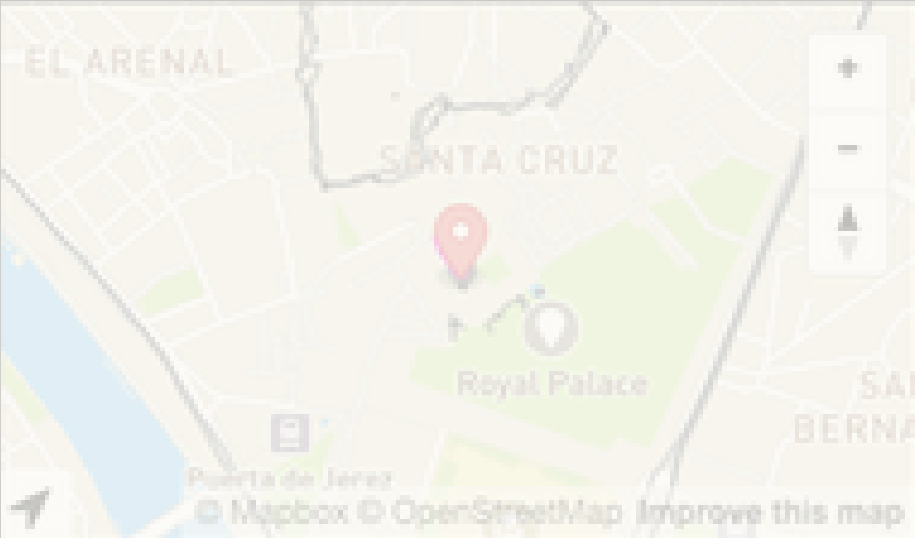


Photo Map Search

Point Cloud Controls



At the same time, it feeds an anonymous GIS system that alerts about incidents before they escalate, generating a heat map that other users can monitor.



Share Hide point cloud Flag

Comments

Photo Details

Time travel (0)

Mapillary is a service for street-level photos.
[Learn more!](#)

Sign up

TOKAY

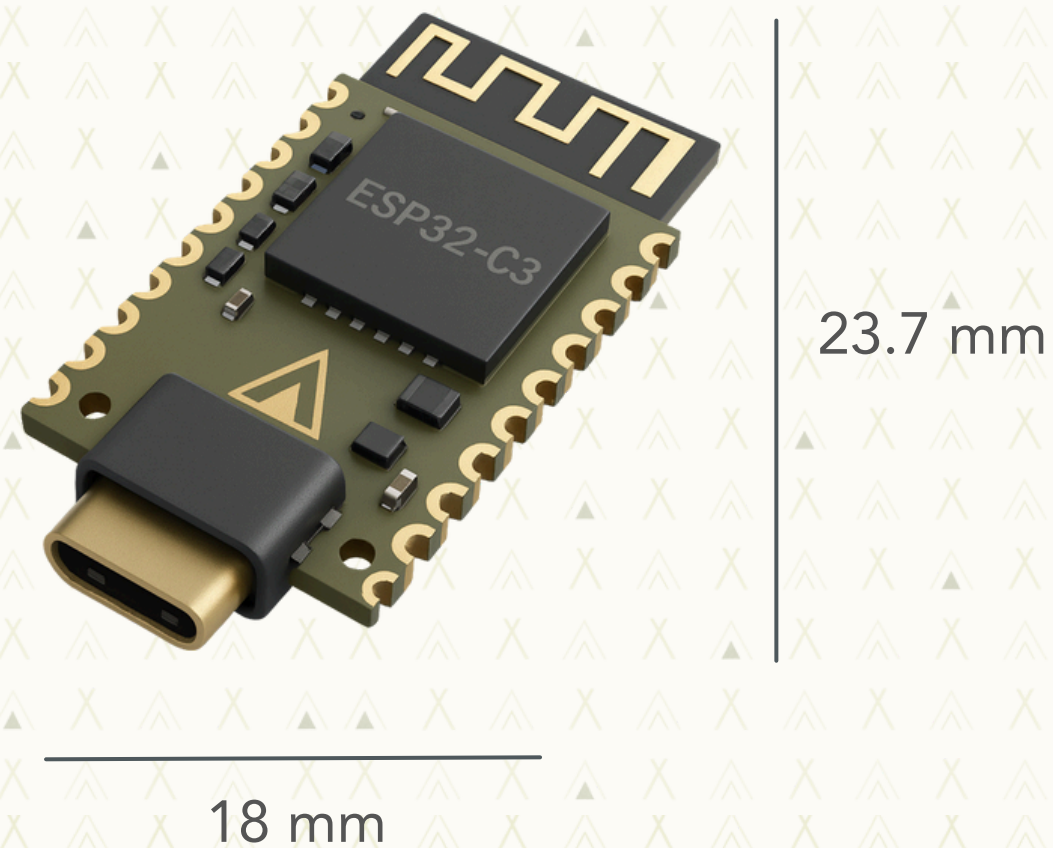
CREATED TO PREVENT

$$\underbrace{\frac{P(L | \mathbf{X})}{1 - P(L | \mathbf{X})}}_{\text{odds posteriores}} = \underbrace{\frac{P(L)}{1 - P(L)}}_{\text{odds previos}} \times \prod_{i=1}^k \underbrace{\frac{P(x_i | L)}{P(x_i | \neg L)}}_{\text{LR}_i}.$$

Tokay will receive AI-powered preventative alerts, based on a Bayesian risk prediction model, fed by user reports and statistical information from reliable sources.



The AdaLead app displays maps and contacts, syncs evidence, adjusts settings, and sends/receives real-time alerts. It also displays micro-credentials available to the user.



Tokay uses an ESP32 C3 Supermini processor to perform SOS alert, communication, and secure logging functions: its RISC-V core with Wi-Fi/BLE 5 links the bracelet to the phone and network; GPIOs control the screen, button, haptics, and IMU; and hardware encryption and low power consumption ensure protected data and good battery life.



Its size and reliability make it the best resource for exploring other formats for tracking and alert devices.

VILLAGES

Villages are open spaces of AdaLead where users and guests meet to build peace, integrate and recognize each other among “tribes” (peaceful resistance networks, activism collectives and families).

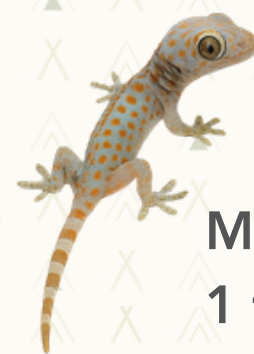
Each Village shares care protocols, conducts micro-courses and alert/support simulations, and establishes mutual support pathways. They serve as safe havens to welcome newcomers, build trust, and coordinate ethical actions related to documentation and protection.

Their common symbol (the tipis) reminds us that the community is the first line of defense.



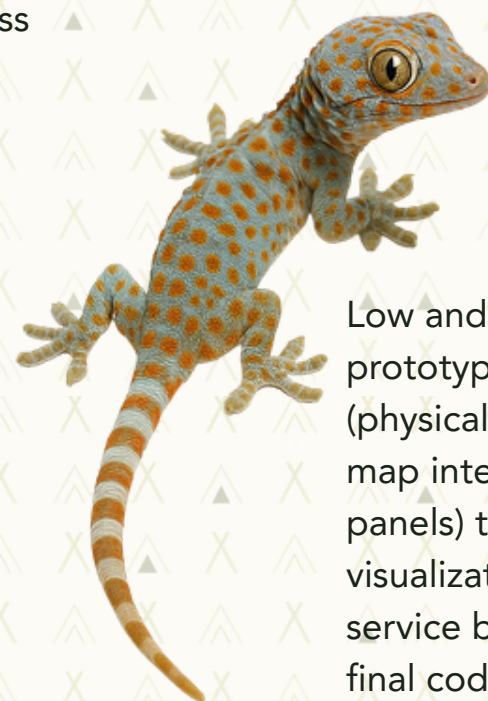


Traction



Months 1 to 4

Surveys and interview scripts were designed specifically for journalists, advocates, and allied organizations, exploring risk perceptions, habitual use of technology, and willingness to pay.



Months 5 to 8

Low and medium fidelity prototypes were developed (physical bracelet, app flows, map interface and alert panels) that allowed visualization of the complete service before programming final code.



Months 9 to 12

Early validation shows high interest in the discreet panic button function, offline operation and articulation with existing support networks; users also highlight the emotional value of "not feeling alone".



Present



Present

Potential pilot projects were identified with journalists' organizations and advocates' networks, and a sales funnel was defined focusing on media outlets, human rights NGOs, and cooperation funds.



Our users' journey



Payment window
B2B
(Bracelets and subscriptions)



Payment window
Low-risk B2C
(Bracelets and subscriptions)



Payment window
High-risk B2C
(Voluntary contribution)



Risk

The user perceives or anticipates a risk and reports the threat through the most secure channel (button in the app or bracelet, keyword, secure line) or a trusted contact reports it. In situations of minor or nonexistent risk, they contact AdaLead via its website.

Secure entrance

AdaLead confirms service in less than five minutes. The user chooses a communication channel and activates incognito mode on the device. A case manager is assigned, a minimal profile is created with clear consent, and a plan is developed for the next few hours.

Onboarding

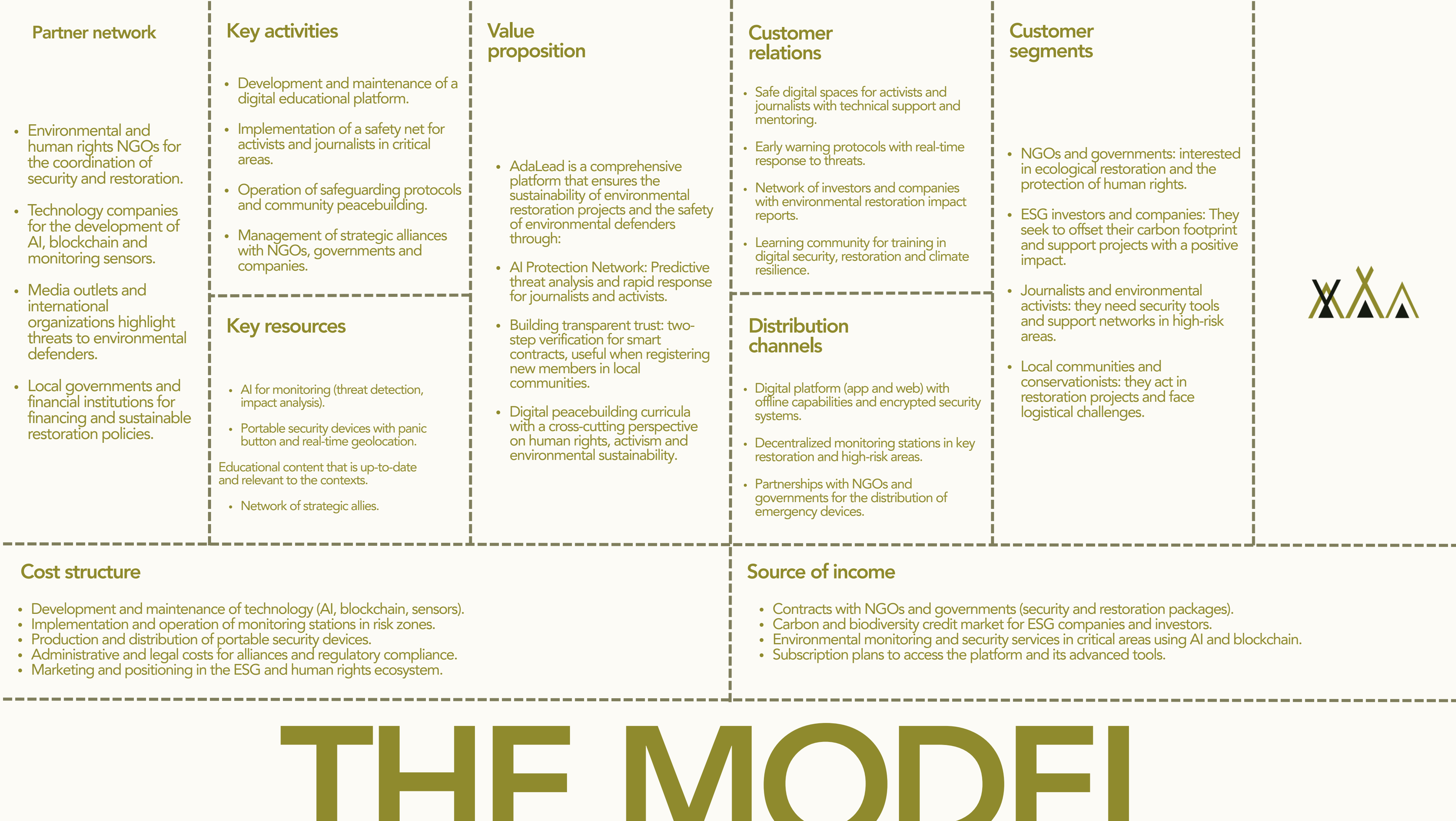
The user describes what happened, their location, and the type of support they require; defines trusted contacts and privacy levels; and tests a virtual button on their phone or wristband. They receive haptic and visual confirmation, agreed-upon and encrypted safety phrases, and offline verification of the delivery.

Containment

The user completes a 5-minute simulation, sets up check-ins and geofences, validates routes, and collects the wristband if applicable. Alerts are delivered to the trusted network even without internet access, with manager support, escalation if the risk increases, and encrypted evidence available.

Belonging

48-hour wellness review; choose continuity (temporary subscription, secure community, or pilot with your organization); schedule drills. Active prevention plan, access to micro-training and a prepared support network; discount option for implementation.





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With the support of

